Wallace has put it, “The Everett interpretation (insofar as it is philosophically acceptable) is the only interpretative strategy currently suited to make sense of quantum physics as we find it.”

But there is another reason, more based in personal style. Essentially everyone agrees that simple, elegant ideas are to be sought after as we search for scientific explanations. Being simple and elegant doesn’t mean an idea is correct—that’s for the data to decide—but when there are multiple ideas vying for supremacy and we don’t yet have enough data to choose among them, it’s natural to give a bit more credence to the simplest and most elegant ones.

The question is, who decides what’s simple and elegant? There are different senses of these terms. Everettian quantum mechanics is absolutely simple and elegant from a certain point of view. A smoothly evolving wave function, that’s all. But the result of these elegant postulates—a proliferating tree of multiple universes—is arguably not very simple at all.

Bohmian mechanics, on the other hand, is constructed in a kind of haphazard way. There are both particles and wave functions, and they interact through a nonlocal guidance equation that seems far from elegant. Including both particles and wave functions as fundamental ingredients is, however, a natural strategy to contemplate, once we have been confronted with the basic experimental demands of quantum mechanics. Matter acts sometimes like waves and sometimes like particles, so we invoke both waves and particles. GRW theory, meanwhile, adds a weird ad hoc stochastic modification to the Schrödinger equation. But it’s arguably the simplest, most brute-force way to physically implement the fact that wave functions appear to collapse.

There is a useful contrast to be drawn between the simplicity of a physical theory and the simplicity with which that theory maps onto reality as we observe it. In terms of basic ingredients, Many-Worlds is unquestionably as simple as it gets. But the distance between what the theory itself says (wave functions, Schrödinger equation) and what we observe in the world (particles, fields, spacetime, people, chairs, stars, planets) seems enormous. Other approaches might be more baroque in their underlying principles, but it’s relatively clear how they account for what we see.